CLEMSON UNIVERSITY

Euroscepticism Revisited

HOW UNCERTAINTY, SOCIAL COHESION, AND INSECURITY SHAPE PUBLIC OPINION AND POPULIST PARTY SUCCESS

Matthew Hansen Wetsel II
15 October 2026

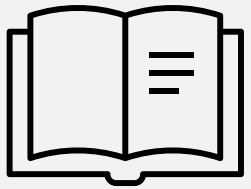


Presentation Overview



Context

TBD



Theory

TBD

$$Y_i = \beta_0 X_0 + \beta_1 X_1 + \varepsilon_i$$

Research Design

TBD

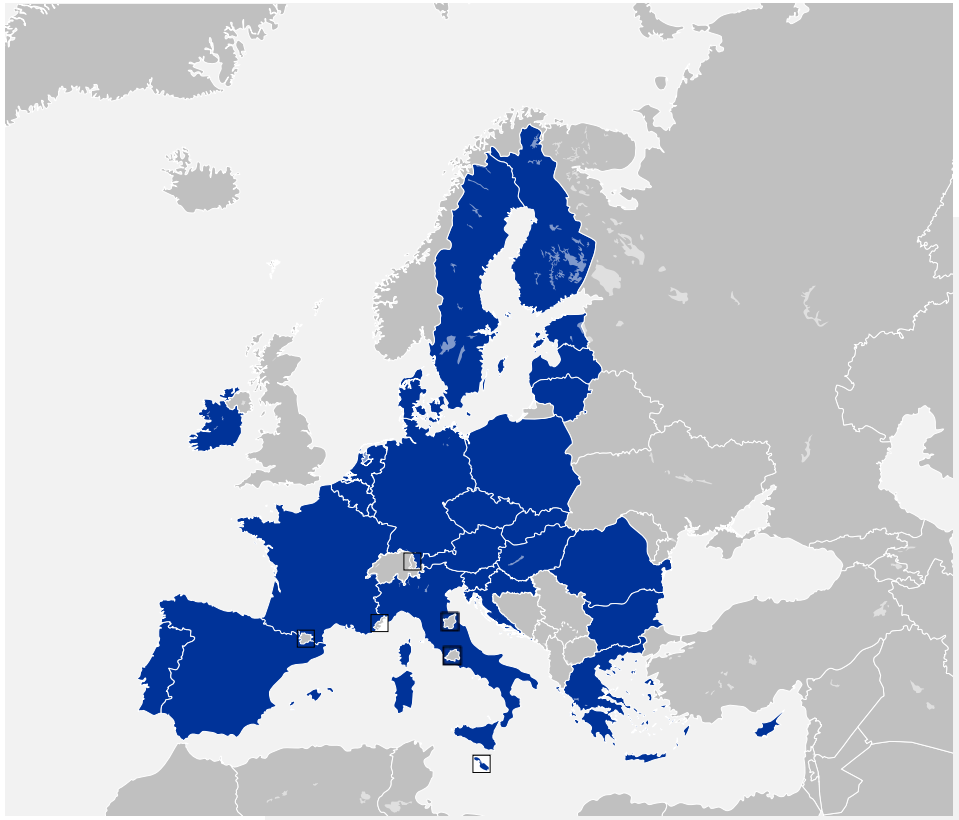


Preliminary Results

TBD

Context

- **RQ**: Why are some Eurosceptic parties more successful than others?
    - Supply & Demand
    - Exogenous Shocks
    - Institutional Path Dependencies



Theory

- **Material**
  - Proxy Benchmarking
  - Social Capital Hypothesis
  - Geographic Inequality
- **Ideational**
  - Political Identity
  - Cultural Backlash
  - Affective Polarization



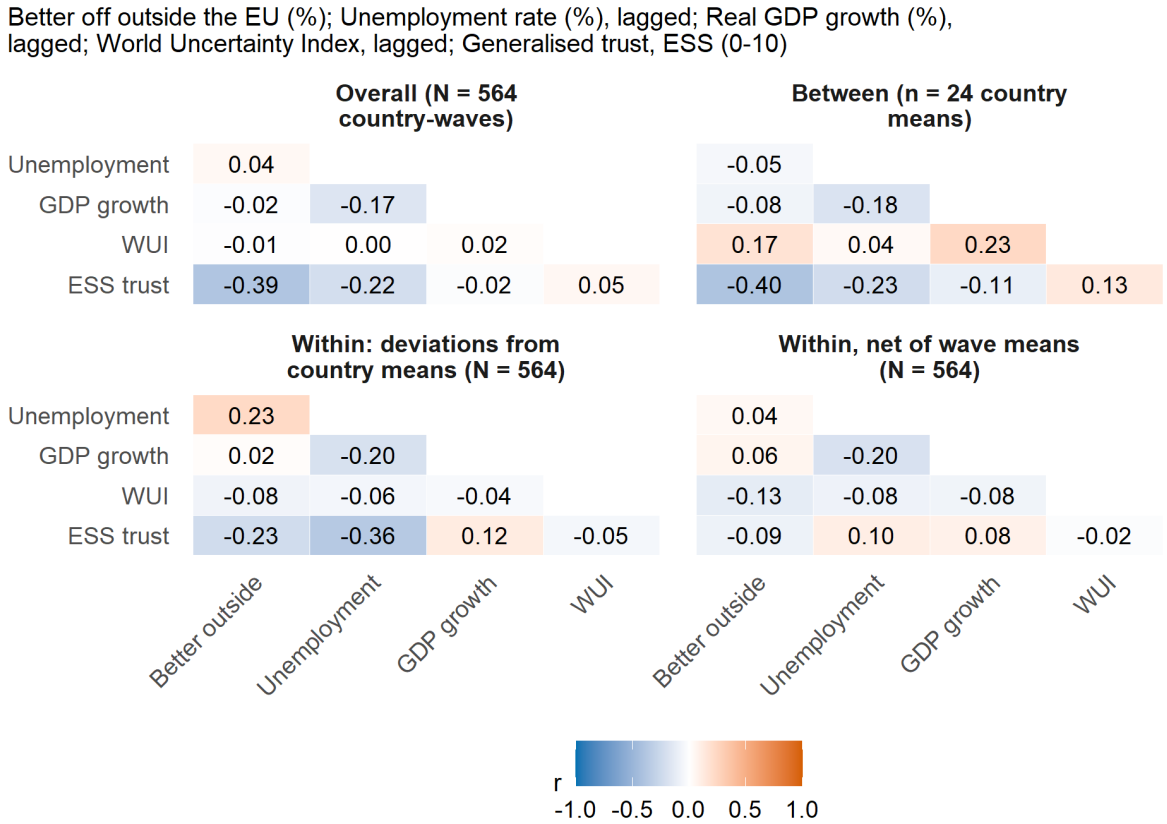
Research Design

H_1: Increased levels of macroeconomic uncertainty will result in higher levels of Euroscepticism.

H_2: A decline in social cohesion will result in higher levels of Euroscepticism.

H_3: Increased levels of individual insecurity will result in higher leels of Euroscepticism.

H_4: There is some complementary effect (interaction) between these three factors and Euroscpeticism.



Data

- Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences
  - https://www.gesis.org/en/eurobarometer-data-service
- The European Social Survey (ESS)
  - https://ess.sikt.no/en
- The World Uncertainty Index
  - https://worlduncertaintyindex.com/data/
- Global Macro Database (GMD)
  - https://www.globalmacrodata.com/
- Eurostat
  - https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/data



Table 1

Eurobarometer country-waves and respondents in the estimation samples, by member state

		C3 · Membership a bad thing (1974–2011)			C1 · Negative image of the EU (2003–2025)			C2 · Better off outside the EU (2012–2024)		
Country		Waves	Period	Respondents	Waves	Period	Respondents	Waves	Period	Respondents
Austria	AT	38	1995–2011	38,838	45	2003–2025	45,442	24	2012–2024	24,333
Belgium	BE	78	1974–2011	80,169	45	2003–2025	45,940	24	2012–2024	24,776
Bulgaria	BG	8	2007–2011	8,053	38	2007–2025	38,865	24	2012–2024	24,780
Croatia	HR	–	–	–	25	2013–2025	25,468	22	2013–2024	22,375
Cyprus	CY	13	2004–2011	6,545	–	–	–	–	–	–
Czechia	CZ	13	2004–2011	13,854	43	2004–2025	44,487	24	2012–2024	24,605
Denmark	DK	78	1974–2011	79,671	45	2003–2025	45,431	24	2012–2024	24,229
Estonia	EE	13	2004–2011	13,034	–	–	–	–	–	–
Finland	FI	38	1995–2011	38,903	46	2003–2025	46,553	24	2012–2024	24,298
France	FR	78	1974–2011	80,303	44	2004–2025	44,563	24	2012–2024	24,292
Germany	DE	77	1974–2011	119,229	45	2003–2025	70,276	24	2012–2024	37,169
Greece	GR	65	1981–2011	66,395	45	2003–2025	45,194	24	2012–2024	24,265
Hungary	HU	13	2004–2011	13,128	43	2004–2025	44,037	24	2012–2024	24,858
Ireland	IE	78	1974–2011	79,236	45	2003–2025	45,332	24	2012–2024	24,276
Italy	IT	78	1974–2011	82,684	45	2003–2025	45,935	24	2012–2024	24,582
Latvia	LV	13	2004–2011	13,139	33	2009–2025	33,179	24	2012–2024	24,266
Lithuania	LT	13	2004–2011	13,194	29	2011–2025	29,254	24	2012–2024	24,248
Luxembourg	LU	78	1974–2011	35,667	–	–	–	–	–	–
Malta	MT	13	2004–2011	6,500	–	–	–	–	–	–
Netherlands	NL	78	1974–2011	80,848	46	2003–2025	46,860	24	2012–2024	24,485
Poland	PL	13	2004–2011	13,000	43	2004–2025	43,265	24	2012–2024	24,343
Portugal	PT	55	1986–2011	56,043	46	2003–2025	46,942	24	2012–2024	24,679

Note. Country-waves are Standard Eurobarometer waves in which the country was a member at fieldwork (accession and exit boundary waves left out) and the outcome and every required predictor are observed; they are the samples of Tables 2–4. Respondents are the member-state respondents asked the item, "don't know" included (the base of the Eurosceptic share), summed over the country's waves; each wave is a fresh cross-section, so no respondent is counted twice within a model. Mean respondents per country-wave: C3 1,034; C1 1,051; C2 1,049. C3 stacks the four wordings of the membership item (Common Market; EC (Common Market); EC; EU). The Eurobarometer files used here do not report response rates, so the table does not show them.

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Eurobarometer country-waves and respondents in the estimation samples, by member state

		C3 · Membership a bad thing (1974–2011)			C1 · Negative image of the EU (2003–2025)			C2 · Better off outside the EU (2012–2024)		
Country		Waves	Period	Respondents	Waves	Period	Respondents	Waves	Period	Respondents
Romania	RO	8	2007–2011	8,167	34	2009–2025	35,016	24	2012–2024	24,944
Slovakia	SK	13	2004–2011	14,007	42	2005–2025	43,268	24	2012–2024	24,558
Slovenia	SI	13	2004–2011	13,229	43	2004–2025	43,669	24	2012–2024	24,459
Spain	ES	55	1986–2011	56,218	45	2003–2025	45,156	24	2012–2024	24,289
Sweden	SE	38	1995–2011	38,455	46	2003–2025	47,128	24	2012–2024	24,710
United Kingdom	GB	78	1974–2011	106,653	34	2003–2019	44,056	14	2012–2019	17,699
Total		**1,136**	**1974–2011**	**1,175,162**	**995**	**2003–2025**	**1,045,316**	**564**	**2012–2024**	**591,518**

Note. Country-waves are Standard Eurobarometer waves in which the country was a member at fieldwork (accession and exit boundary waves left out) and the outcome and every required predictor are observed; they are the samples of Tables 2–4. Respondents are the member-state respondents asked the item, "don't know" included (the base of the Eurosceptic share), summed over the country's waves; each wave is a fresh cross-section, so no respondent is counted twice within a model. Mean respondents per country-wave: C3 1,034; C1 1,051; C2 1,049. C3 stacks the four wordings of the membership item (Common Market; EC (Common Market); EC; EU). The Eurobarometer files used here do not report response rates, so the table does not show them.

Table 2

Question wordings of the Eurosceptic dependent variables, Standard Eurobarometer

Model	Item · series	Question wording	Answer categories (Eurosceptic answer in bold)	Fielded (member states)	In the model sample
Dependent variables (Tables 2–4)					
C3	E01 · MEMB_cm	*Generally speaking, do you think that (OUR COUNTRY'S) membership of the Common Market is a good thing, a bad thing, or neither good nor bad?*	A good thing; neither good nor bad; **a bad thing**; DK	EB2 (1974) – EB16 (1981); 15 waves	EB2 (1974) – EB16 (1981); 15 waves, 13 country-waves
C3	E01 · MEMB_eccm	*Generally speaking, do you think that (YOUR COUNTRY'S) membership of the European Community (Common Market) is ...?*	A good thing; **a bad thing**; neither good nor bad; DK	EB17 (1982) – EB34.0 (1990); 18 waves	EB17 (1982) – EB34.((1990); 18 waves, 19 country-waves
C3	E01 · MEMB_ec	*Generally speaking, do you think that (OUR COUNTRY'S) membership of the European Community is ...? (READ OUT)*	A good thing; **a bad thing**; neither good nor bad; DK	EB35.0 (1991) – EB40 (1993); 6 waves	EB35.0 (1991) – EB4((1993); 6 waves, 72 country-waves
C3	E01 · MEMB_eu	*Generally speaking, do you think that (OUR COUNTRY'S) membership of the European Union is ...?*	A good thing; **a bad thing**; neither good nor bad; DK	EB42 (1994) – EB91.5 (2019); 40 waves	EB42 (1994) – EB75.3 (2011); 39 waves, 72 country-waves
C1	E05 · IMG	*In general, does the EU conjure up for you a very positive, fairly positive, neutral, fairly negative or very negative image?*	Very positive; fairly positive; neutral; **fairly negative; very negative**; DK	EB53 (2000) – EB104.1 (2025); 50 waves	EB59.1 (2003) – EB1((2025); 46 waves, 99 country-waves
C2	E06 · OUT_orig	*To what extent do you agree or disagree with each of the following statements? ... (OUR COUNTRY) could better face the future outside the EU.*	**Totally agree; tend to agree**; tend to disagree; totally disagree; DK	EB78.1 (2012) – EB102.2 (2024); 24 waves	EB78.1 (2012) – EB1((2024); 24 waves, 56 country-waves
–	E06 · OUT_rev	*To what extent do you agree or disagree with each of the following statements? ... (OUR COUNTRY) can better face the future inside the EU than outside the EU.*	Totally agree; tend to agree; tend to disagree; totally disagree; DK (agreement now means support)	not in agg_country_wave_series	not modelled

Note. Eurosceptic shares count only the answers in bold, with "don't know" kept in the base. "(OUR COUNTRY)" stands for the country name; "..." marks omitted battery items. Fielded: Standard waves in the model sample: waves and country-waves left after the sample rules of script 09. Item codes follow the Measurement Audit (section 07, master alignment map); wordings are verbatim from the s

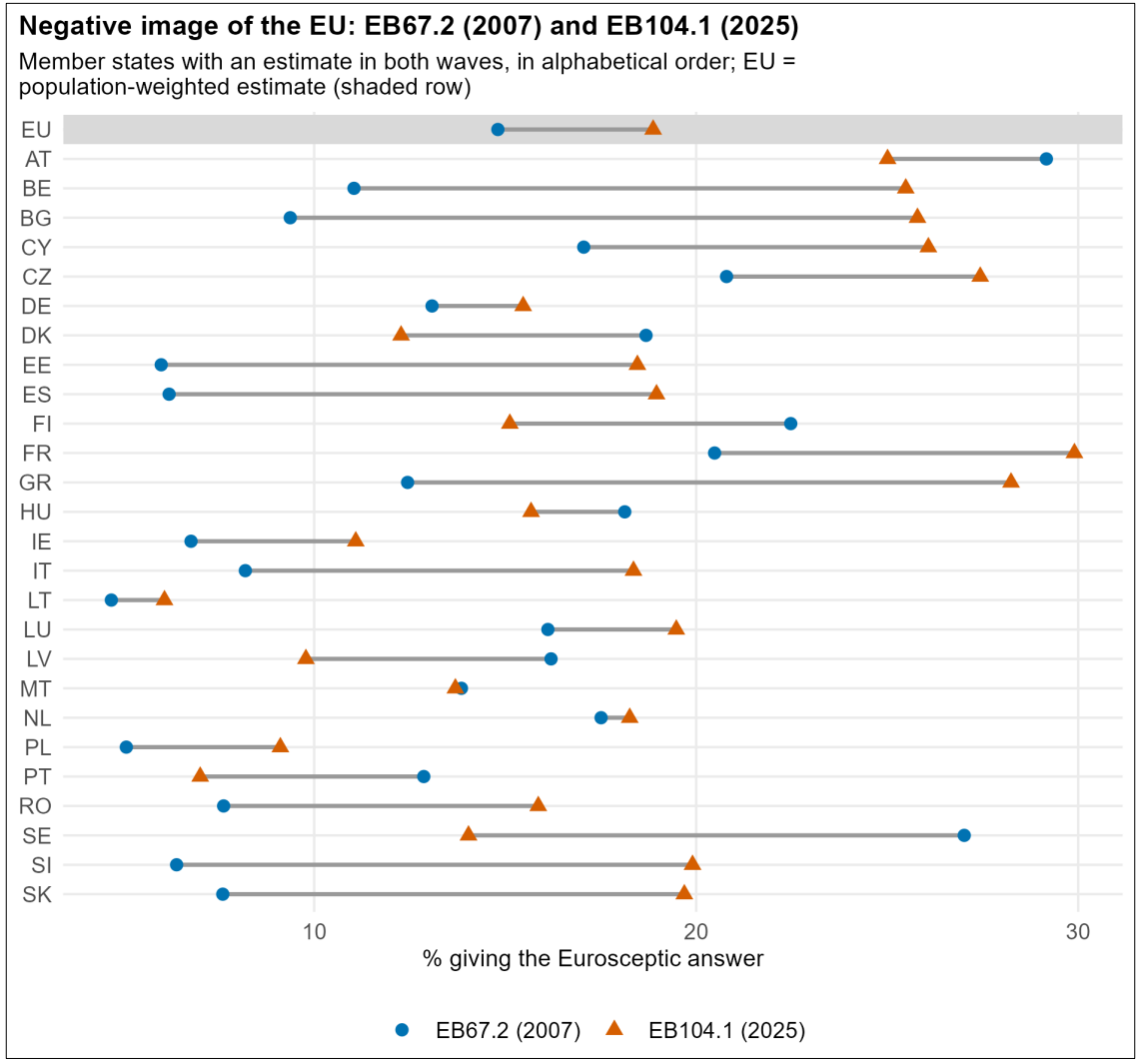
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Model	Item · series	Question wording	Answer categories (Eurosceptic answer in bold)	Fielded (member states)	In the model sample
Descriptive diffuse-support series (slide 9; not modelled)					
–	E07 · TRUST	*How much trust do you have in certain institutions? For each of the following institutions, do you tend to trust it or tend not to trust it? … The European Union*	Tend to trust; **tend not to trust**; DK	EB48.0 (1997) – EB101.3 (2024); 48 waves	not modelled
–	E08 · DEMS	*On the whole, are you very satisfied, fairly satisfied, not very satisfied or not at all satisfied with the way democracy works in (OUR COUNTRY)? And how about the way democracy works in the EU?*	Very satisfied; fairly satisfied; **not very satisfied; not at all satisfied**; DK	EB39.0 (1993) – EB104.1 (2025); 51 waves	not modelled
–	E09 · FUT	*Would you say that you are very optimistic, fairly optimistic, fairly pessimistic or very pessimistic about the future of the EU?*	Very optimistic; fairly optimistic; **fairly pessimistic; very pessimistic**; DK	EB67.2 (2007) – EB104.1 (2025); 36 waves	not modelled

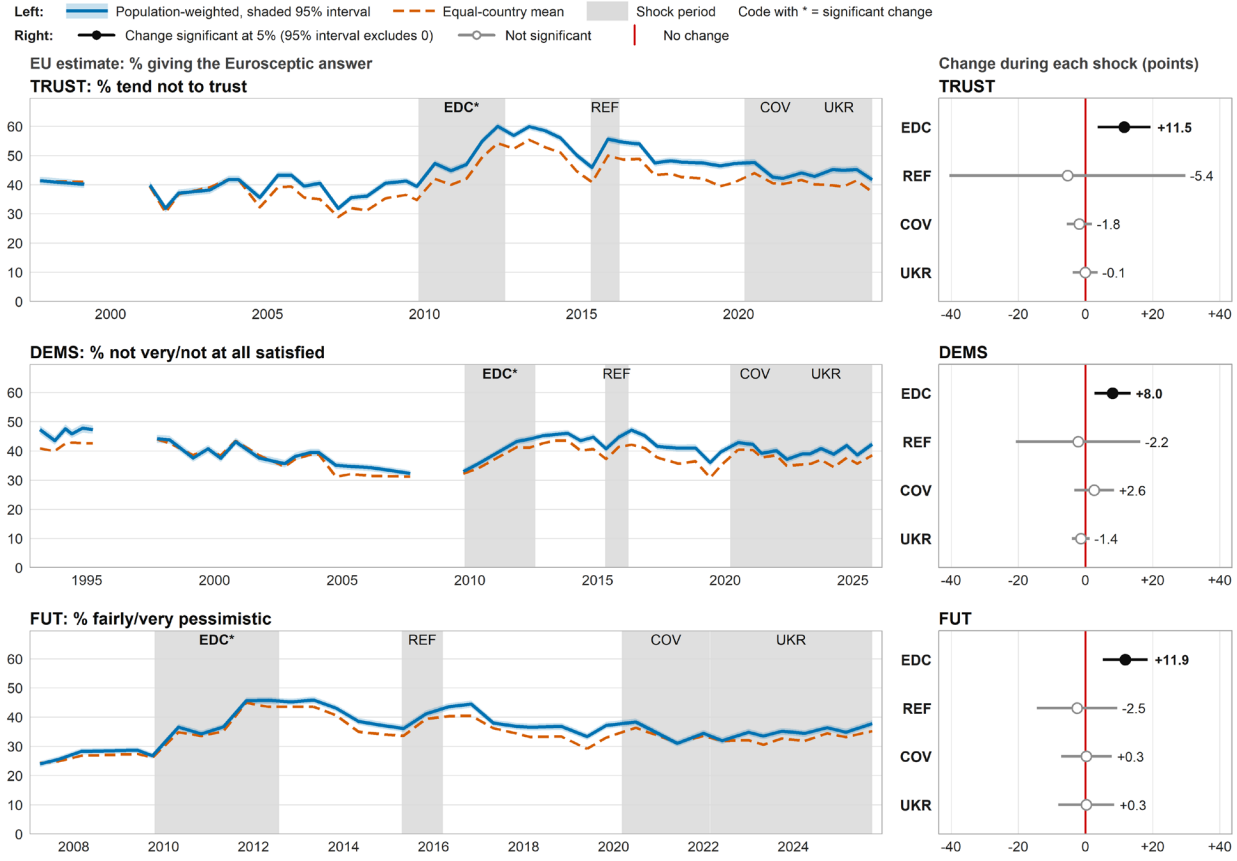
Note. Eurosceptic shares count only the answers in bold, with "don't know" kept in the base. "(OUR COUNTRY)" stands for the country name; "…" marks omitted battery items. Fielded: Standard waves in the model sample: waves and country-waves left after the sample rules of script 09. Item codes follow the Measurement Audit (section 07, master alignment map); wordings are verbatim from the s

Preliminary Findings (1)


Negative image of the EU: EB67.2 (2007) and EB104.1 (2025)
Member states with an estimate in both waves, in alphabetical order; EU = population-weighted estimate (shaded row)
EU
AT
BE
BG
CY
CZ
DE
DK
EE
ES
FI
FR
GR
HU
IE
IT
LT
LU
LV
MT
NL
PL
PT
RO
SE
SI
SK
10
20
30
% giving the Eurosceptic answer
EB67.2 (2007)
EB104.1 (2025)

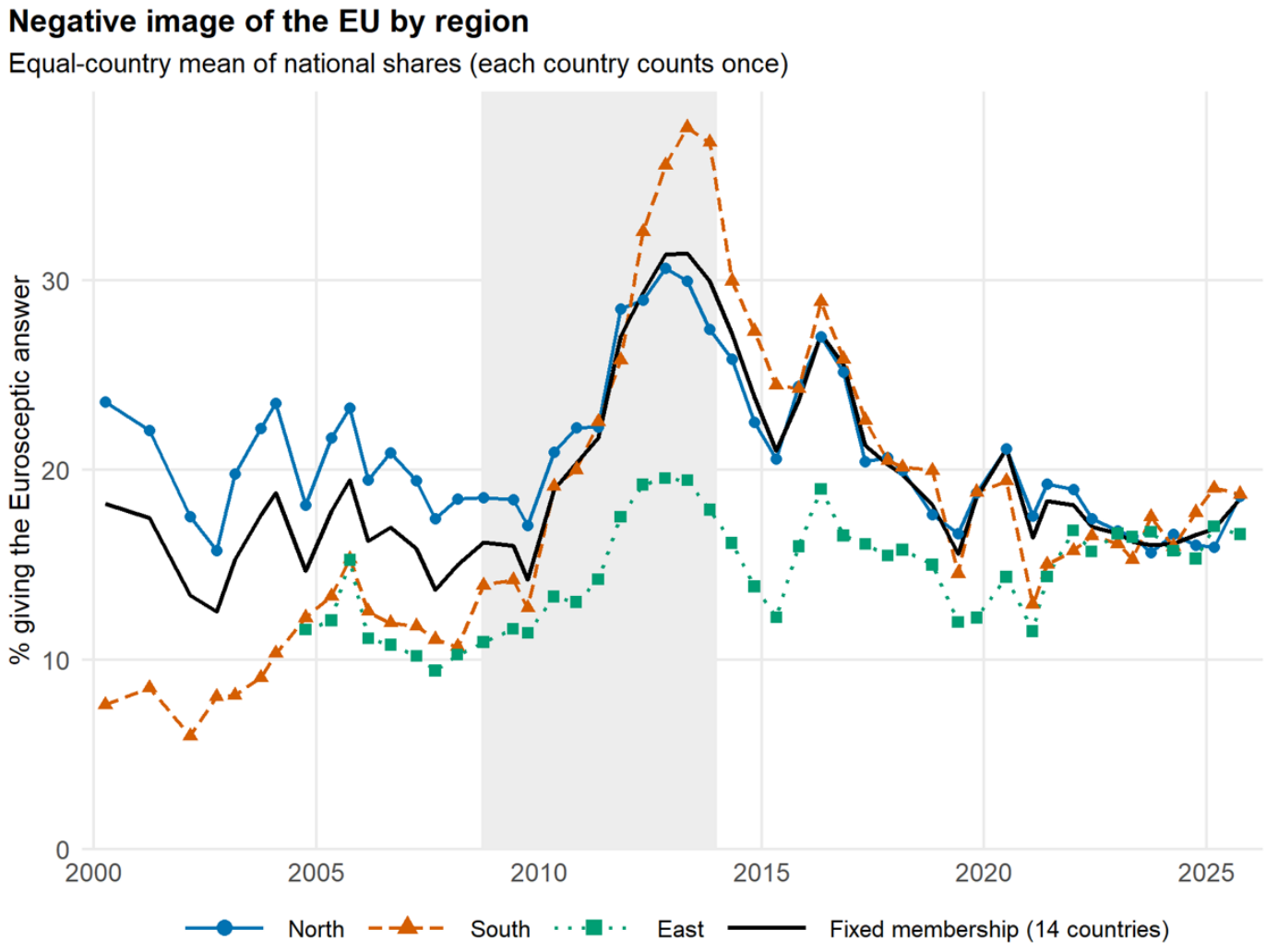
Euroscepticism in the EU and exogenous shocks, 1974-2025 (3 of 3): TRUST, DEMS, FUT

Left: EU estimate over the member states surveyed in each wave. Right: change during each shock against the two years before. Codes: table below.



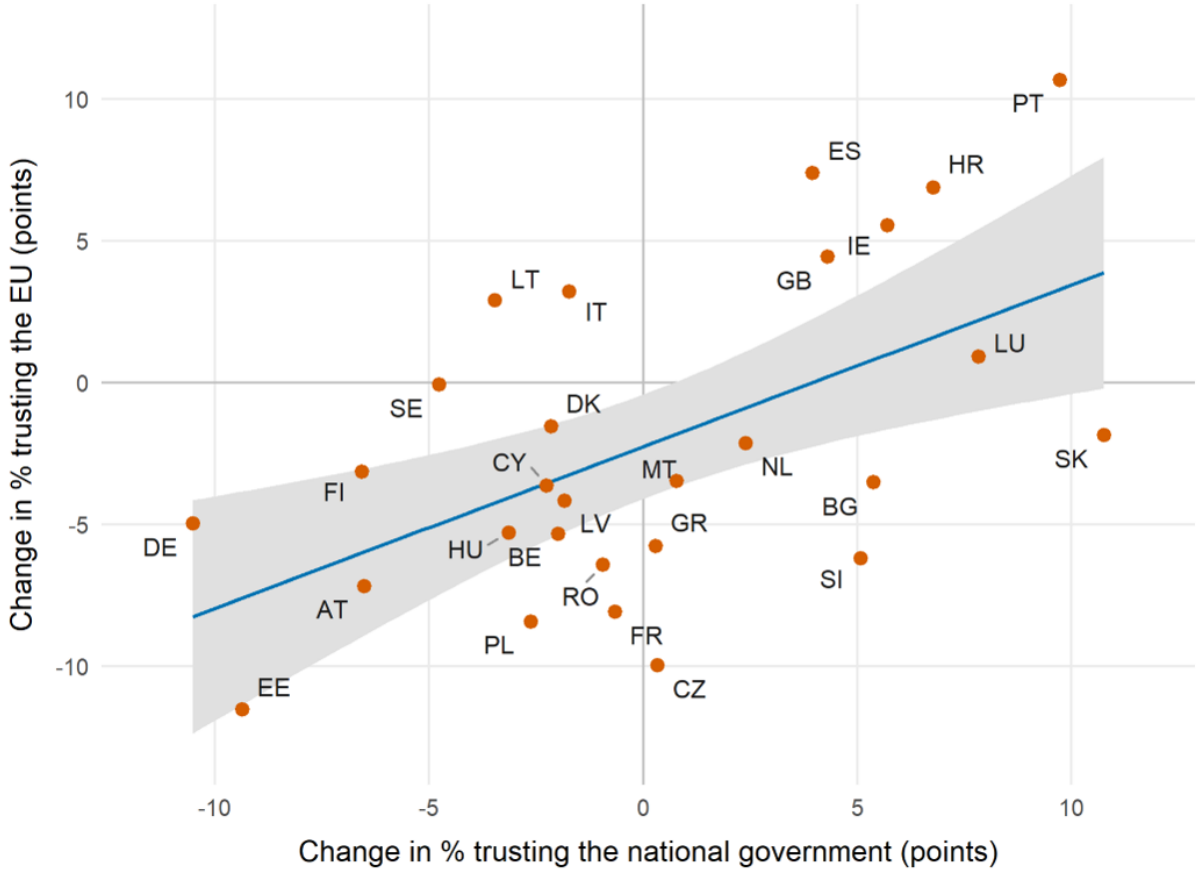
Exogenous shocks (shaded periods)			Change (points)		
Code	Event	Period	TRUST	DEMS	FUT
EDC	Euro debt crisis	Oct 2009 - Jul 2012	**+11.5***	**+8.0***	**+11.9***
REF	Refugee crisis	Apr 2015 - Mar 2016	-5.4	-2.2	-2.5
COV	COVID-19 pandemic	Mar 2020 - Feb 2022	-1.8	+2.6	+0.3
UKR	War in Ukraine	from Feb 2022	-0.1	-1.4	+0.3

Preliminary Findings (2)


Negative image of the EU by region
Equal-country mean of national shares (each country counts once)
% giving the Eurosceptic answer
0
10
20
30
2000
2005
2010
2015
2020
2025
North
South
East
Fixed membership (14 countries)

Rising trust at home, falling trust in the EU ?
The refugee crisis

Country changes from 2014 (EB81.4, EB82.3) to Nov 2015 to spring 2016 (EB84.3, EB85.2), valid answers; n = 28, r = 0.56, slope = 0.57 (SE 0.17)



Statistical Analysis (1)

Table 2. Country-level models of Euroscepticism: two-way fixed effects, with inflation

C1 + inflation — Negative image of the EU

Number of obs	995	**R-squared**	0.730
Number of clusters (countries)	24	**Adj R-squared**	0.708
Time units	46 waves	**Within R-squared**	0.125
Period	2003–2025	**Within adj R-squared**	0.120
Fixed effects	country, wave_id	**Wald F**	F(5, 944) = 3.44, Prob > F = 0.004
Root MSE (pp)	4.61	**AIC / BIC**	−3,152.4 / −2,789.6

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Unemployment rate (%)	0.61†	0.28	2.21	0.037	[0.04, 1.18]	0.078	[−0.08, 1.22]
GDP growth (%)	−0.32*	0.11	−2.82	0.010	[−0.56, −0.09]	0.021	[−0.63, −0.08]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.30**	0.11	2.83	0.009	[0.08, 0.52]	0.004	[0.11, 0.55]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1)	−0.38	6.65	−0.06	0.954	[−14.14, 13.37]	0.957	[−13.57, 13.88]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10)	0.77	3.15	0.24	0.809	[−5.76, 7.29]	0.815	[−5.92, 7.89]

C1 + national cue + inflation — Negative image of the EU

Number of obs	984	**R-squared**	0.747
Number of clusters (countries)	24	**Adj R-squared**	0.727
Time units	45 waves	**Within R-squared**	0.181
Period	2003–2025	**Within adj R-squared**	0.176
Fixed effects	country, wave_id	**Wald F**	F(6, 933) = 5.15, Prob > F = <0.001
Root MSE (pp)	4.44	**AIC / BIC**	−3,186.8 / −2,824.8

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Unemployment rate (%)	0.37	0.29	1.30	0.206	[−0.22, 0.96]	0.342	[−0.29, 1.00]
GDP growth (%)	−0.28*	0.10	−2.94	0.007	[−0.48, −0.08]	0.026	[−0.53, −0.06]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.28**	0.10	2.92	0.008	[0.08, 0.48]	0.001	[0.11, 0.51]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1)	−0.71	5.94	−0.12	0.906	[−12.99, 11.57]	0.912	[−12.62, 11.67]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10)	1.50	3.07	0.49	0.630	[−4.85, 7.85]	0.646	[−5.14, 8.22]
Trust in national government, t−1 (share)	−15.22**	4.27	−3.56	0.002	[−24.06, −6.38]	0.002	[−24.17, −5.94]

C2 + inflation — Country better off outside the EU

Number of obs	564	**R-squared**	0.794
Number of clusters (countries)	24	**Adj R-squared**	0.774
Time units	24 waves	**Within R-squared**	0.047
Period	2012–2024	**Within adj R-squared**	0.038
Fixed effects	country, wave_id	**Wald F**	F(5, 535) = 3.08, Prob > F = 0.009
Root MSE (pp)	4.14	**AIC / BIC**	−1,888.9 / −1,663.4

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Unemployment rate (%)	0.17	0.29	0.59	0.564	[−0.43, 0.78]	0.593	[−0.59, 0.73]
GDP growth (%)	0.17†	0.10	1.62	0.119	[−0.05, 0.38]	0.069	[−0.01, 0.52]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.33†	0.19	1.78	0.088	[−0.05, 0.72]	0.067	[−0.02, 0.82]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1)	−12.45*	4.73	−2.63	0.015	[−22.24, −2.66]	0.017	[−22.55, −2.55]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10)	−3.05	1.96	−1.55	0.134	[−7.11, 1.01]	0.145	[−7.24, 1.25]

C2 + national cue + inflation — Country better off outside the EU

Number of obs	563	**R-squared**	0.795
Number of clusters (countries)	24	**Adj R-squared**	0.774
Time units	24 waves	**Within R-squared**	0.051
Period	2012–2024	**Within adj R-squared**	0.040
Fixed effects	country, wave_id	**Wald F**	F(6, 533) = 2.56, Prob > F = 0.019
Root MSE (pp)	4.13	**AIC / BIC**	−1,885.1 / −1,655.4

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Unemployment rate (%)	0.13	0.30	0.42	0.675	[−0.49, 0.74]	0.705	[−0.63, 0.70]
GDP growth (%)	0.17†	0.11	1.57	0.131	[−0.05, 0.39]	0.097	[−0.01, 0.53]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.33†	0.18	1.82	0.083	[−0.05, 0.71]	0.064	[−0.02, 0.80]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1)	−12.39*	4.68	−2.65	0.014	[−22.07, −2.71]	0.018	[−22.48, −2.47]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10)	−2.73	1.86	−1.47	0.156	[−6.58, 1.12]	0.173	[−6.68, 1.38]
Trust in national government, t−1 (share)	−3.99	5.20	−0.77	0.451	[−14.75, 6.77]	0.482	[−14.82, 7.34]

C3 + inflation — Membership is a bad thing (stacked wordings)

Number of obs	1,136	**R-squared**	0.789
Number of clusters (countries)	27	**Adj R-squared**	0.767
Time units	78 waves	**Within R-squared**	0.104
Period	1974–2011	**Within adj R-squared**	0.101
Fixed effects	country, wave_id, segment	**Wald F**	F(3, 1052) = 8.90, Prob > F = <0.001
Root MSE (pp)	4.11	**AIC / BIC**	−3,805.3 / −3,251.4

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Unemployment rate (%)	0.49***	0.11	4.35	<0.001	[0.26, 0.72]	<0.001	[0.25, 0.72]
GDP growth (%)	−0.24†	0.11	−2.15	0.041	[−0.47, −0.01]	0.051	[−0.48, 0.00]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.43*	0.19	2.30	0.030	[0.05, 0.81]	0.046	[0.02, 0.90]

C3, country × wording fixed effects + inflation — Membership is a bad thing

Number of obs	1,136	**R-squared**	0.864
Number of clusters (countries)	27	**Adj R-squared**	0.845
Time units	78 waves	**Within R-squared**	0.027
Period	1974–2011	**Within adj R-squared**	0.024
Fixed effects	country^segment, wave_id	**Wald F**	F(3, 1055) = 2.76, Prob > F = 0.041
Root MSE (pp)	3.31	**AIC / BIC**	−4,238.9 / −3,528.9

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Unemployment rate (%)	0.22	0.13	1.64	0.113	[−0.06, 0.50]	0.182	[−0.12, 0.49]
GDP growth (%)	−0.16†	0.08	−1.93	0.064	[−0.34, 0.01]	0.078	[−0.34, 0.03]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.20	0.12	1.66	0.109	[−0.05, 0.45]	0.109	[−0.05, 0.49]

Note: OLS on country-wave shares of the Standard Eurobarometer; outcome = share giving the Eurosceptic answer (DK in the base). Coefficients, standard errors and intervals × 100 (percentage points per one-unit change in the predictor). Std. err., t, P>|t| and the 95% interval are cluster-robust by country (CR1, t with G − 1 df). Bootstrap = wild cluster restricted bootstrap (Webb weights, B = 9,999, null imposed), clustered by country; interval by test inversion. Stars use the bootstrap p: † p < 0.10, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001. Wald F: joint test of all shown coefficients with the clustered covariance. Root MSE in percentage points. Inflation: Eurostat HICP, all items, annual rate of change (prc_hicp_manr), last month released (month end + 30 days) before fieldwork starts; before each country's first HICP month (1997 in most countries), annual CPI inflation from the Global Macro Database (World Bank where it lacks a year), counted as available 60 days after the year ends, shifted to the HICP level where the gap in the first 2 HICP years exceeds 0.5 points. Samples are complete cases including inflation; see Table_09_infl_vs_baseline.csv for the models without it.

Statistical Analysis (2)

Table 3. Within- and between-country effects: random-effects within/between models, with inflation

C1 within/between + inflation — Negative image of the EU

Number of obs	995	**Marginal R-squared**	0.359
Number of groups (countries)	24	**Conditional R-squared**	0.752
Time units	46 waves (fixed effects)	**Intraclass correlation**	0.61
Period	2003–2025	**SD country intercept / residual (pp)**	6.0 / 4.8
Estimation	REML, Satterthwaite df	**AIC / BIC**	−2,654.9 / −2,370.5

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	df	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]
Intercept	26.04	18.27	1.43	18	0.171	[−12.32, 64.41]
Unemployment rate (%) — within	0.61***	0.07	9.28	921	<0.001	[0.48, 0.74]
GDP growth (%) — within	−0.32***	0.07	−4.94	921	<0.001	[−0.45, −0.19]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y) — within	0.30**	0.11	2.89	921	0.004	[0.10, 0.51]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1) — within	−0.29	3.67	−0.08	921	0.936	[−7.49, 6.91]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10) — within	0.80	0.97	0.83	921	0.409	[−1.10, 2.70]
Unemployment rate (%) — between	−0.54	0.52	−1.04	18	0.311	[−1.64, 0.55]
GDP growth (%) — between	−3.00*	1.19	−2.53	18	0.021	[−5.50, −0.51]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y) — between	−1.61	2.02	−0.80	18	0.436	[−5.86, 2.64]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1) — between	70.94	84.78	0.84	18	0.414	[−107.13, 249.01]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10) — between	0.12	1.91	0.06	18	0.953	[−3.89, 4.12]

C2 within/between + inflation — Country better off outside the EU

Number of obs	564	**Marginal R-squared**	0.222
Number of groups (countries)	24	**Conditional R-squared**	0.814
Time units	24 waves (fixed effects)	**Intraclass correlation**	0.76
Period	2012–2024	**SD country intercept / residual (pp)**	7.7 / 4.3
Estimation	REML, Satterthwaite df	**AIC / BIC**	−1,545.0 / −1,389.0

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	df	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]
Intercept	38.31	24.07	1.59	18	0.129	[−12.24, 88.87]
Unemployment rate (%) — within	0.17	0.11	1.49	512	0.136	[−0.05, 0.39]
GDP growth (%) — within	0.17*	0.08	2.02	512	0.044	[0.00, 0.33]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y) — within	0.33**	0.12	2.91	512	0.004	[0.11, 0.56]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1) — within	−12.46**	4.60	−2.71	512	0.007	[−21.50, −3.42]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10) — within	−3.04*	1.33	−2.28	512	0.023	[−5.66, −0.42]
Unemployment rate (%) — between	−0.28	0.61	−0.45	18	0.655	[−1.55, 1.00]
GDP growth (%) — between	−1.59	1.27	−1.25	18	0.226	[−4.26, 1.08]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y) — between	1.70	3.02	0.56	18	0.580	[−4.64, 8.04]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1) — between	107.42	77.10	1.39	18	0.180	[−54.42, 269.27]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10) — between	−4.14†	2.28	−1.82	18	0.085	[−8.93, 0.64]

C3 within/between + inflation — Membership is a bad thing

Number of obs	1,136	**Marginal R-squared**	0.170
Number of groups (countries)	27	**Conditional R-squared**	0.774
Time units	78 waves (fixed effects)	**Intraclass correlation**	0.73
Period	1974–2011	**SD country intercept / residual (pp)**	7.1 / 4.3
Estimation	REML, Satterthwaite df	**AIC / BIC**	−3,098.2 / −2,665.2

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	df	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]
Intercept	20.55**	6.51	3.16	26	0.004	[7.17, 33.93]
Unemployment rate (%) — within	0.49***	0.06	7.61	1,031	<0.001	[0.36, 0.61]
GDP growth (%) — within	−0.25***	0.06	−4.15	1,031	<0.001	[−0.36, −0.13]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y) — within	0.43***	0.06	7.50	1,036	<0.001	[0.32, 0.54]
Unemployment rate (%) — between	0.01	0.50	0.02	23	0.986	[−1.03, 1.05]
GDP growth (%) — between	−2.60	1.83	−1.42	23	0.169	[−6.38, 1.18]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y) — between	−0.80	0.71	−1.13	23	0.270	[−2.27, 0.67]

Note: Linear mixed models (REML): random country intercept, wave fixed effects (and wording-segment intercepts in C3), not shown. Within = deviation from the country mean on the estimation sample; between = country mean. Coefficients × 100. t tests with Satterthwaite df (lmerTest); † p < 0.10, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001. These standard errors are model-based and do not allow for serial correlation within countries, so the WITHIN standard errors are too small: use Table 2 for within-country inference. R-squared after Nakagawa and Schielzeth. Inflation: Eurostat HICP, all items, annual rate of change (prc_hicp_manr), last month released (month end + 30 days) before fieldwork starts; before each country's first HICP month (1997 in most countries), annual CPI inflation from the Global Macro Database (World Bank where it lacks a year), counted as available 60 days after the year ends, shifted to the HICP level where the gap in the first 2 HICP years exceeds 0.5 points. Samples are complete cases including inflation; see Table_09_infl_vs_baseline.csv for the models without it.

Statistical Analysis (3)

Table 4. Short- and long-run dynamics: error-correction models (country half-years), with inflation

C1 error-correction model + inflation — Δ Negative image of the EU

Number of obs	835	**R-squared**	0.417
Number of clusters (countries)	24	**Adj R-squared**	0.362
Time units	half-years	**Within R-squared**	0.130
Period	2003–2025	**Within adj R-squared**	0.118
Fixed effects	country, period	**Wald F**	F(11, 785) = 16.47, Prob > F = <0.001
Root MSE (pp)	2.86	**AIC / BIC**	−3,422.9 / −3,077.7

Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Eurosceptic share, t−1 (adjustment rate)	−0.215***	0.027	−8.06	<0.001	[−0.270, −0.160]	—	—
Δ Unemployment rate (%)	0.61*	0.27	2.30	0.031	[0.06, 1.16]	0.040	[0.03, 1.15]
Δ GDP growth (%)	−0.09	0.05	−1.73	0.098	[−0.20, 0.02]	0.158	[−0.23, 0.06]
Δ Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	−0.01	0.09	−0.11	0.916	[−0.19, 0.17]	0.919	[−0.21, 0.17]
Δ Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1)	0.08	2.53	0.03	0.974	[−5.16, 5.33]	0.975	[−5.04, 5.31]
Δ Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10)	1.63	1.30	1.25	0.223	[−1.06, 4.33]	0.237	[−1.31, 4.47]
Unemployment rate (%), t−1	0.04	0.06	0.64	0.529	[−0.09, 0.17]	0.620	[−0.11, 0.19]
GDP growth (%), t−1	−0.07	0.05	−1.36	0.186	[−0.19, 0.04]	0.320	[−0.17, 0.10]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y), t−1	−0.10	0.06	−1.64	0.114	[−0.22, 0.03]	0.119	[−0.21, 0.02]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1), t−1	1.64	2.62	0.63	0.537	[−3.79, 7.07]	0.545	[−3.74, 7.05]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10), t−1	0.20	0.81	0.25	0.804	[−1.47, 1.88]	0.813	[−1.58, 1.93]

C2 error-correction model + inflation — Δ Country better off outside the EU

Number of obs	422	**R-squared**	0.330
Number of clusters (countries)	24	**Adj R-squared**	0.238
Time units	half-years	**Within R-squared**	0.197
Period	2013–2024	**Within adj R-squared**	0.173
Fixed effects	country, period	**Wald F**	F(11, 393) = 17.15, Prob > F = <0.001
Root MSE (pp)	3.10	**AIC / BIC**	−1,631.0 / −1,420.7

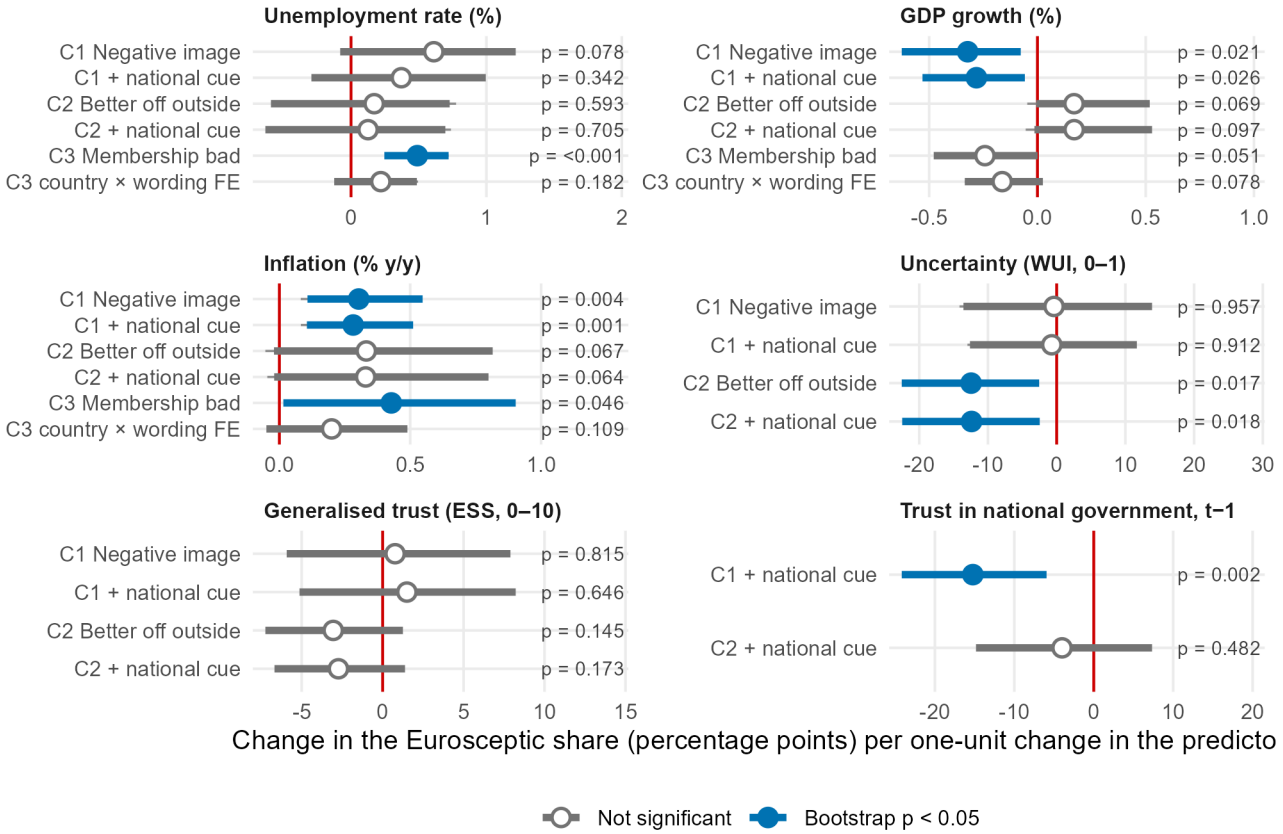
Variable	Coef.	Std. err.	t	P>|t|	[95% conf. interval]	Bootstrap P	Bootstrap [95% CI]
Eurosceptic share, t−1 (adjustment rate)	−0.371***	0.047	−7.82	<0.001	[−0.469, −0.273]	—	—
Δ Unemployment rate (%)	0.01	0.36	0.04	0.970	[−0.72, 0.75]	0.970	[−0.84, 0.80]
Δ GDP growth (%)	0.05	0.08	0.70	0.489	[−0.11, 0.21]	0.498	[−0.17, 0.36]
Δ Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y)	0.21	0.18	1.14	0.265	[−0.17, 0.59]	0.277	[−0.17, 0.70]
Δ Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1)	−3.31	3.80	−0.87	0.392	[−11.17, 4.55]	0.379	[−11.99, 4.33]
Δ Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10)	−0.10	1.61	−0.06	0.949	[−3.43, 3.22]	0.950	[−3.37, 3.57]
Unemployment rate (%), t−1	0.15	0.12	1.27	0.216	[−0.10, 0.40]	0.342	[−0.13, 0.42]
GDP growth (%), t−1	0.12*	0.08	1.57	0.130	[−0.04, 0.29]	0.020	[0.01, 0.40]
Inflation, consumer prices (% y/y), t−1	0.18	0.14	1.29	0.208	[−0.11, 0.47]	0.220	[−0.11, 0.53]
Uncertainty (WUI, 0–1), t−1	−1.05	4.54	−0.23	0.818	[−10.44, 8.33]	0.812	[−10.80, 8.01]
Generalised trust (ESS, 0–10), t−1	−1.49	1.16	−1.29	0.210	[−3.88, 0.90]	0.218	[−4.00, 1.04]

Note: Outcome: half-year change in the Eurosceptic share; lags only where the previous half-year is observed. Coefficients × 100 except the adjustment rate (unscaled). Cluster-robust standard errors by country; bootstrap as in Table 2 for the Δ and lagged-predictor terms (the adjustment rate is not bootstrapped). Stars: bootstrap p where shown, otherwise the clustered p. Long-run effect of a predictor = −(its lag coefficient) / (adjustment rate). Inflation of a half-year = value of its earliest wave. Inflation: Eurostat HICP, all items, annual rate of change (prc_hicp_manr), last month released (month end + 30 days) before fieldwork starts; before each country's first HICP month (1997 in most countries), annual CPI inflation from the Global Macro Database (World Bank where it lacks a year), counted as available 60 days after the year ends, shifted to the HICP level where the gap in the first 2 HICP years exceeds 0.5 points. Samples are complete cases including inflation; see Table_09_infl_vs_baseline.csv for the models without it.

Data Visualization

What moves Euroscepticism within countries, and how sure we can be

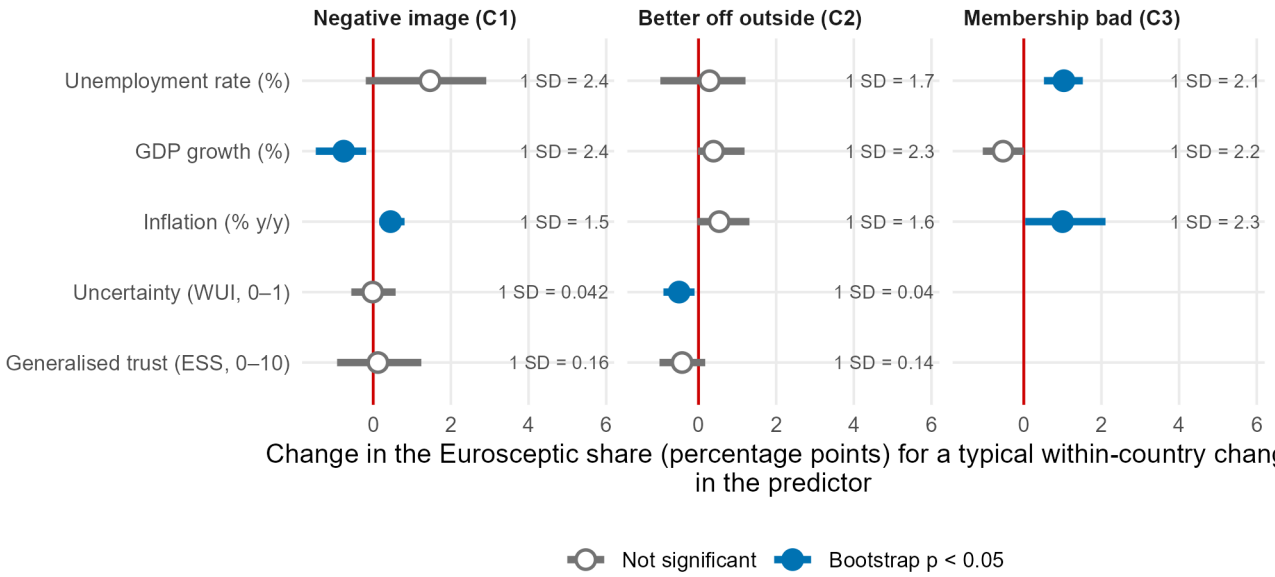
Two-way fixed-effects estimates; thick line = wild cluster bootstrap 95% interval, thin grey line = clustered 95% interval; p = bootstrap p



Country-wave shares, Standard Eurobarometer; country and wave fixed effects (C3: also wording segments, or country × wording). Bootstrap: wild cluster restricted, Webb weights, B = 9,999, clustered by country (24–27 clusters); p-values shown are bootstrap p. Units of the predictors differ: compare signs and significance within a panel; Fig09_2 compares sizes on one scale. All models include inflation (HICP annual rate, % y/y; annual CPI inflation before 1997), timed like the other macro predictors.

How large are the effects? A typical within-country change in each predictor

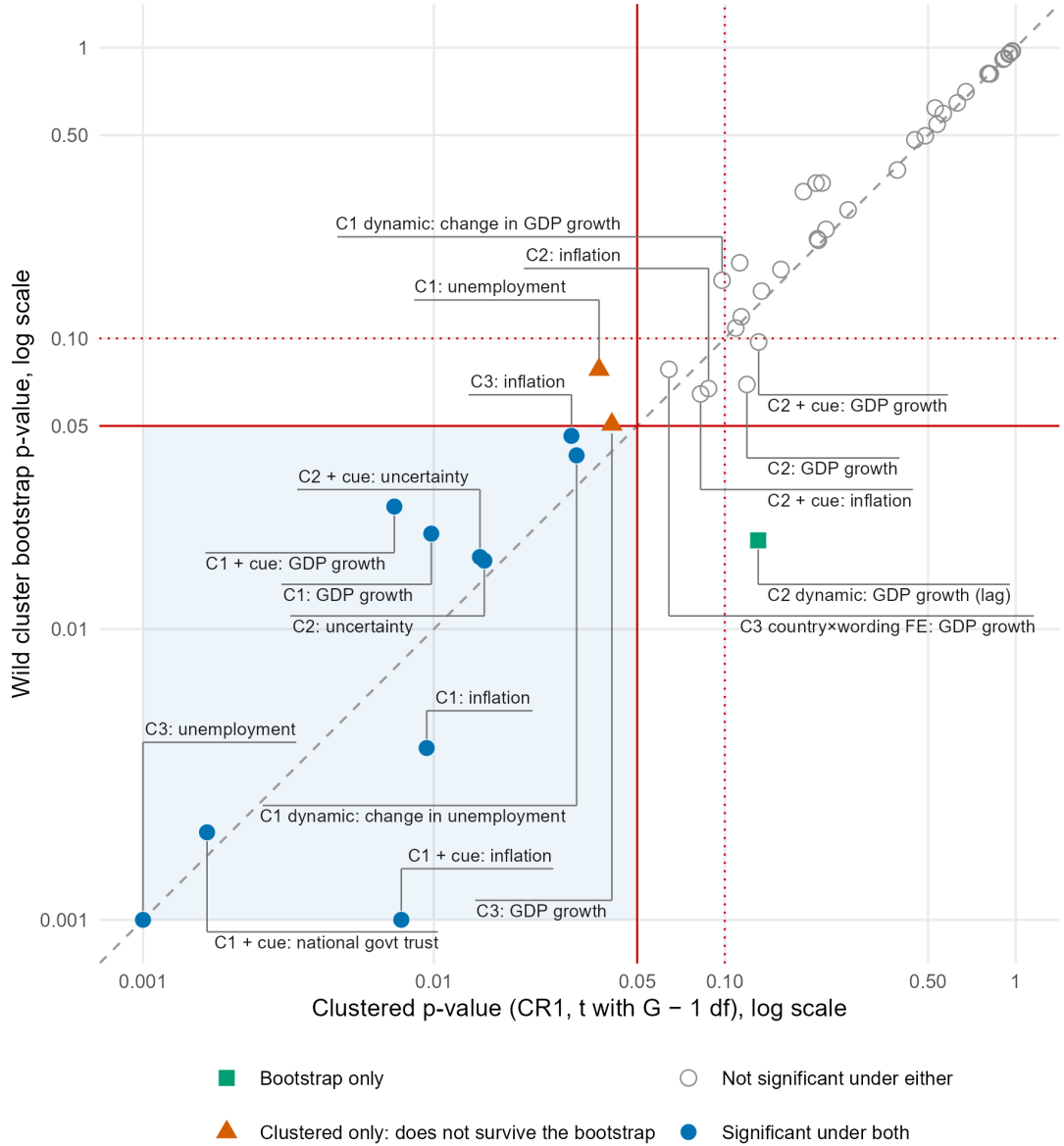
Coefficient × the predictor's standard deviation left after country and wave fixed effects; bootstrap 95% interval



The SD is computed on each model's own sample after removing country and wave means (09, sheet variance_left). Generalised trust barely moves within countries (SD about 0.15 on a 0–10 scale), so its within-country effect is small by construction. All models include inflation (HICP annual rate, % y/y; annual CPI inflation before 1997), timed like the other macro predictors.

Do the findings survive the wild cluster bootstrap?

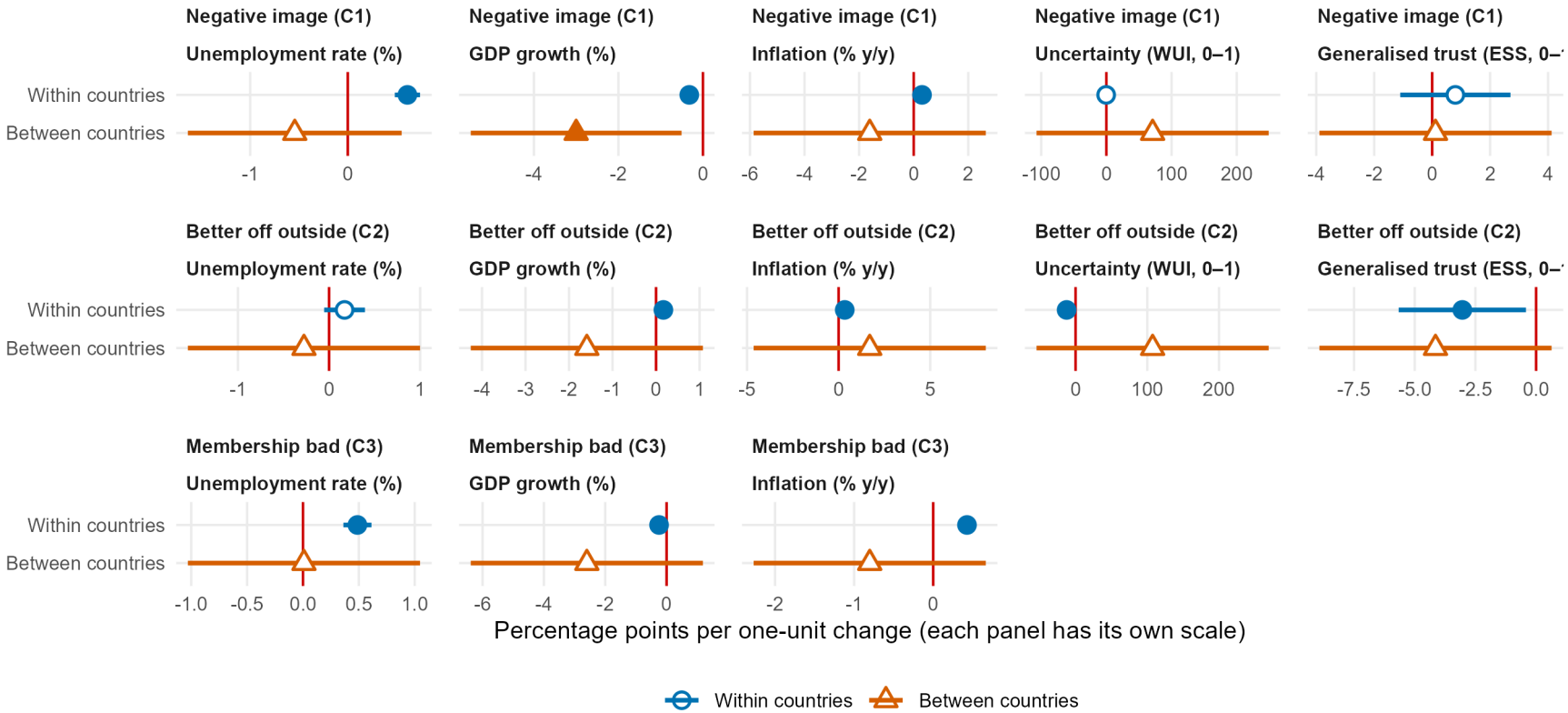
Every bootstrapped term in 09 (models with inflation); solid lines at p = 0.05, dotted at 0.10; shaded = significant under both



With 24–27 countries, clustered standard errors can be too optimistic; points above the dashed line lose precision under the bootstrap. Labelled: terms with p < 0.10 under either method (all terms: Fig09_3_bootstrap_vs_clustered_data.csv); '+ cue' = with trust in the national government; 'dynamic' = error-correction model. p-values below 0.001 are drawn at 0.001. All models include inflation (HICP annual rate, % y/y; annual CPI inflation before 1997), timed like the other macro predictors.

Within-country change versus differences between countries

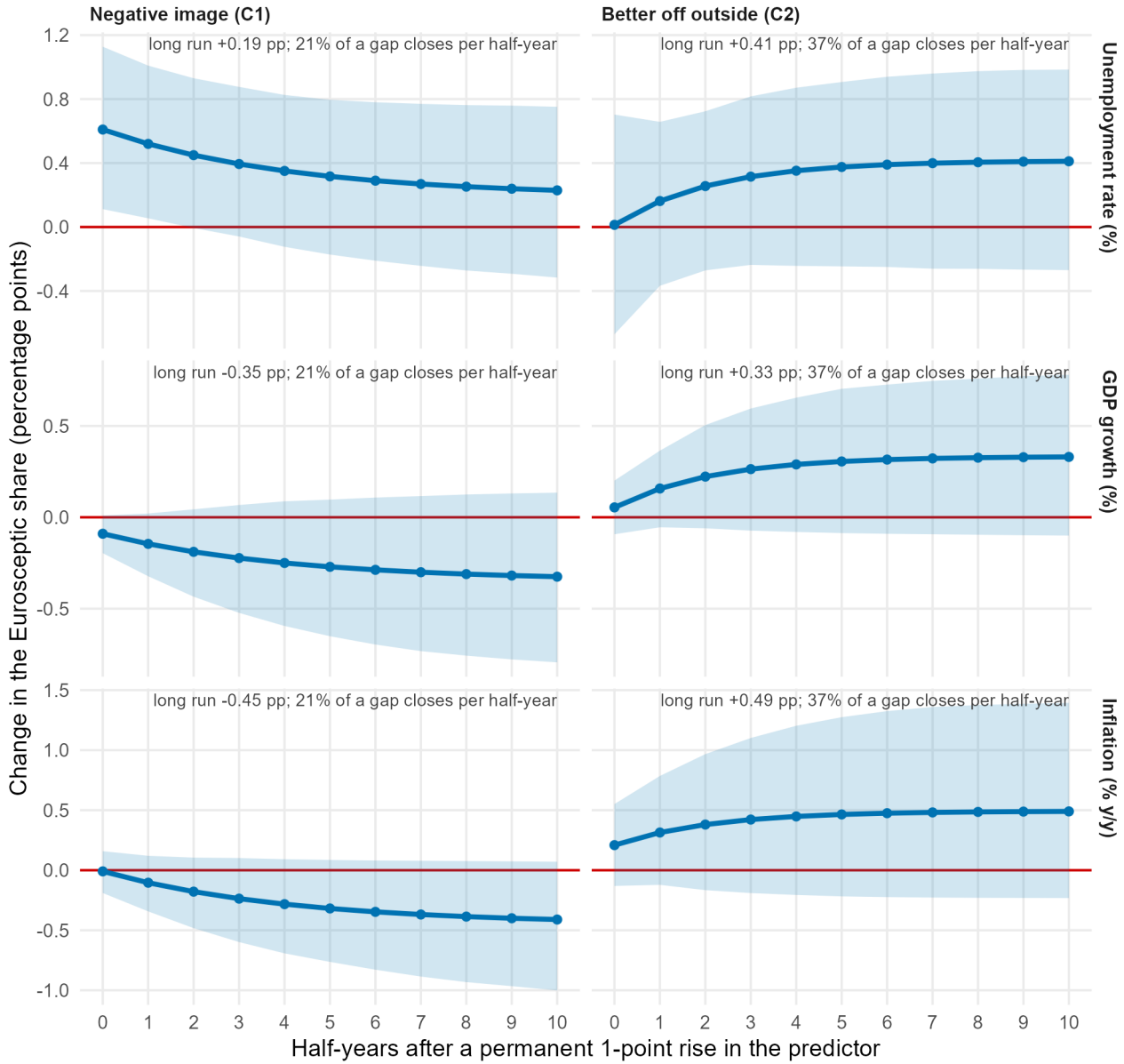
Random-effects within/between models; one row per outcome, one column per predictor;
filled symbol = p < 0.05 (model-based); 95% intervals



Within = a country's deviation from its own mean; between = the country mean. Model-based standard errors understate the uncertainty of the within terms (no allowance for serial correlation): see Fig09_1 for within-country inference.
All models include inflation (HICP annual rate, % y/y; annual CPI inflation before 1997), timed like the other macro predictors.

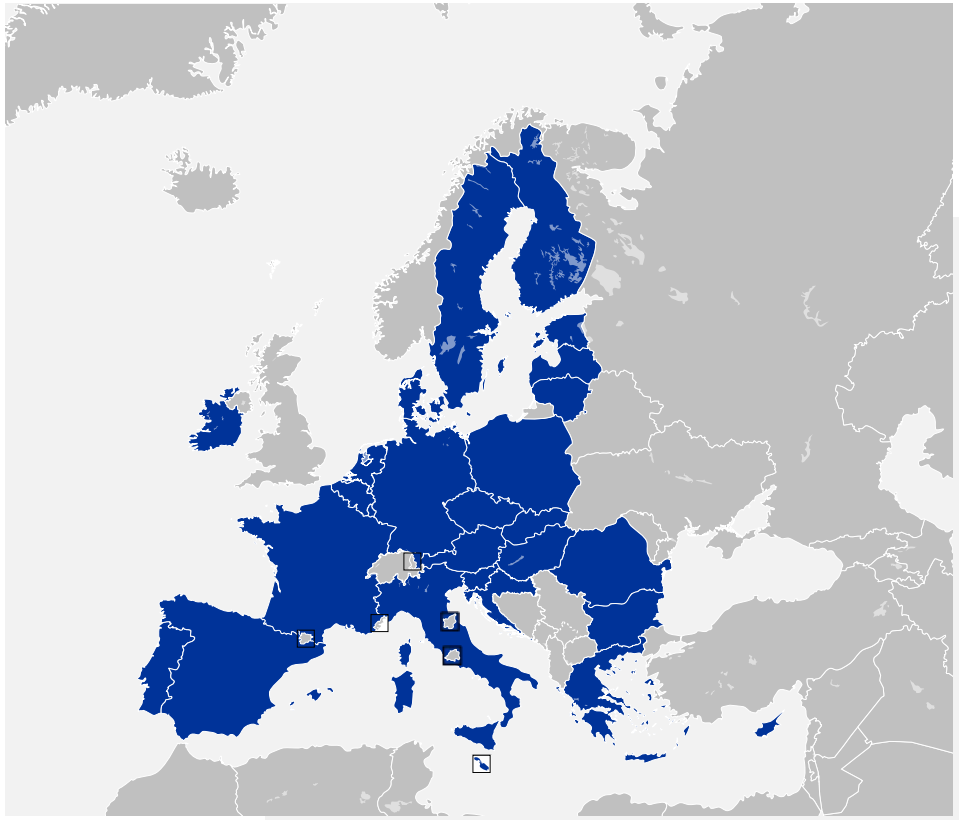
How fast do economic shocks reach Euroscepticism, and do they last?

Error-correction models (country half-years); line = point estimate, band = 95% simulation interval



Path implied by dy = a·y(t−1) + b·dx + c·x(t−1): impact b, then each half-year closes a share −a of the gap to the long-run effect −c/a. Band: 2000 draws from the clustered covariance of (a, b, c). Lags exist only where the previous half-year was observed. All models include inflation (HICP annual rate, % y/y; annual CPI inflation before 1997), timed like the other macro predictors.

Conclusion



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